

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineering Consultant | SIEM Engineering, SOC Automation and Detection Development

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Security Engineering Consultant with over five years of hands-on experience helping organisations improve, mature and automate their Security Operations Centre (SOC) functions, tooling and detection capabilities. My core expertise spans Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) engineering with Microsoft Sentinel and Kusto Query Language (KQL), Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) development, and detection content engineering aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework. I have led the design and deployment of detection playbooks, automated triage workflows and SIEM-integrated toolchains at enterprise scale, enabling faster and more consistent response to real threats. I combine deep technical proficiency with the ability to advise stakeholders at all levels on SOC capability improvements and security programme maturity. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and CompTIA Security+ alongside Microsoft and Google credentials.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- SIEM Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (preferred), Kusto Query Language (KQL), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Splunk Search Processing Language (SPL), detection rule development, data connector configuration, SIEM onboarding
- SOC Automation and SOAR:** SOAR playbook development and optimisation, automated triage workflows, alert enrichment, orchestration integrations, PowerShell scripting
- Detection Engineering:** Custom detection rule authoring, MITRE ATT&CK-aligned use-case development, alert tuning, false-positive reduction, threat hunting
- Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon EDR (Prevent, Insight, Discover), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI)
- Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus, Rapid7
- Identity and Cloud Security:** Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), Microsoft Intune / Mobile Device Management (MDM)
- Frameworks:** NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Lead SIEM engineering across CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, designing and deploying detection rules, KQL-based analytics, and SOAR playbooks to automate SOC functions and improve detection fidelity across an 8,000-user estate.
- Drive SOC capability improvement through detection content maturity reviews, alert tuning and automation of repetitive triage tasks, significantly reducing analyst workload and improving signal-to-noise ratio.
- Develop and maintain SOAR automation workflows integrating CrowdStrike, Sentinel, Mimecast and BeyondTrust PAM to orchestrate response across endpoint, identity and email security domains.
- Build and refine MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection use cases to close coverage gaps and improve visibility of lateral movement, persistence and exfiltration tactics, techniques and procedures (TTPs).
- Conduct threat hunting exercises, leveraging KQL and Falcon Insight telemetry to proactively identify indicators of compromise before alert thresholds are breached.
- Oversee vulnerability management cycles using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS, producing risk-based remediation plans aligned to business priorities.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Designed, deployed and tuned SIEM detection content in CrowdStrike Falcon and Microsoft Sentinel, expanding detection coverage from reactive alerting to proactive threat hunting capability.
- Built automated SOAR playbooks for phishing, malware triage and account compromise response, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) by 35% and enabling consistent, repeatable remediation processes.
- Performed structured analysis of security telemetry from endpoint, network and identity sources, correlating events to identify complex multi-stage attack patterns.
- Managed endpoint security through CrowdStrike Falcon and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, maintaining full device visibility and enforcing security policies across a heterogeneous device fleet.
- Administered identity security controls using Entra ID, Conditional Access, MFA and BeyondTrust PAM, reducing privileged account risk and improving access governance.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / Financial Technology)

- Contributed to security operations and infrastructure monitoring within a cloud-hosted SaaS FinTech environment, supporting detection, incident response and configuration management.
- Developed PowerShell-based automation scripts for log collection and anomaly alerting, providing early warning of unauthorised access and configuration drift.
- Conducted security quality assurance reviews of infrastructure and application controls, supporting ISO 27001 compliance and internal audit readiness.
- Assisted with endpoint security tooling deployment and managed vulnerability scanning, coordinating remediation with development and infrastructure teams.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and deployed a full SIEM detection content library in Microsoft Sentinel covering 60+ MITRE ATT&CK techniques, increasing detection coverage by 40% within the first year at UAL.
- Authored 40+ SOAR playbooks integrating CrowdStrike, Sentinel and Mimecast APIs, automating containment and notification workflows and reducing analyst mean time to respond (MTTR) by 35%.
- Led CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM onboarding across the full UAL estate, completing data source integration and initial tuning ahead of project schedule.
- Introduced structured threat hunting cadence using Falcon Insight and KQL, resulting in identification and remediation of three previously undetected persistent threats over a 12-month period.
- Delivered NIST Cybersecurity Framework (NIST CSF) maturity assessment and improvement roadmap that underpinned successful Cyber Essentials Plus recertification ahead of schedule.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Remote (UK)